

Engine
3.0-litre 6-cyl turbocharged petrol

Power
381bhp@5,200-6,250rpm

Price
₹1.82 crore (ex-showroom)

BMW 740i M SPORT





rear bumper, at least in the case of the car sent to us for review, and only one 20-inch option for the alloys is what BMW offers for the 740i. Also part of the standard package is the lit-up kidney grille or 'Iconic Glow' function and LED DRLs with Swarovski crystals.

Once you step inside, any misgivings about the exterior start fading into irrelevance. The cabin combines contemporary luxury with just the right helping of ostentatious. The leather-draped cabin and wood finish trims blend beautifully with crystal glass elements, including the iDrive dial, gear selector, seat adjustment controls and, most notably, the crystalline glass light bar that runs the width of the dashboard onto the doors. It incorporates stunning lighting effects making for an exceptional in-cabin experience. True to the nature of the 7 Series, though, it's the rear half of the cabin that impresses the most and is likely to make a prospective buyer look past its rivals. We won't be surprised if the full-recline boss mode for the left rear passenger seat and the theatre mode are reason enough for some to put their money down on the new 7 Series; it's that impressive. Electrically adjustable seats, massage functions, and seat heating/cooling are all par for the segment, but just the way one interacts with the car to use these through the touchscreens incorporated in the doors makes it feel that much more special.

Air suspension ensures ride comfort is excellent and so is the sound insulation making this such a great car to be driven around in. But where the 7 Series really stands out vis-a-vis rivals is when you get behind the wheel. Despite its size and heft, this is actually an enjoyable car to drive. Of course, 381bhp helps and so does engaging Sport/Sport Plus mode, but more than that it's that uniquely BMW ability to shrink around the driver so you never really realise the sheer size of this car as you move across lanes trying to get past slow-moving traffic. Honestly, if you're shopping for a flagship luxury sedan and intend to drive it yourself, even occasionally, there's nothing like the 7 Series out there. It does the whole 'relaxed when you're in the back seat, sporty when you're behind the wheel' better than its competitors by a fair margin. The one we drove had the 3.0-litre 6-cylinder turbo petrol with 381bhp and 520Nm capable of sprinting from 0 to 100kmph in 5.4 seconds. There's also the 740d, the diesel variant, with a 3.0-litre engine producing 286bhp and 650Nm enabling a 0-100kmph time of 6.0 seconds. Both get assistance from a 48V electric motor that outputs 18bhp and 200Nm, and an 8-speed torque converter is standard. The new 7 Series doesn't feature drive modes in the traditional sense. It gets something called 'My Modes' that goes beyond just altering steering, suspension and powertrain characteristics, affecting factors like display colours, ambient lighting and even seat massage operation. Of course, settings are customisable and the familiar Eco and Sport options are still very much there. Driver assistance comes in the form of features like lane keep assist, blind spot assistant and forward collision warning, but the car won't brake on its own, which, given the haphazard nature of traffic on our roads, is a good thing as that avoids what is at times unnecessary emergency braking since these systems simply aren't that well calibrated for our market. ■